

INTERVIEW IDENTITY

Experienced Tier 1/Tier 2 corporate IT support specialist with measurable service results across Windows/Mac, AD/Entra/M365, SCCM/MECM deployment, networking, AV, mobile devices, CMDB and escalation. Sound like an independent support IC: methodical, customer-focused, technically curious, and accountable through closure.

MUST REMEMBER - COMPANY | ROLE | CV PROOF**COMPANY FACTS**

- Global Technology is a shared technology services model supporting News Corp businesses including Dow Jones, HarperCollins, New York Post and Realtor.com.
- News Corp operates across information/news, digital real estate and book publishing; primary markets include the U.S., Australia and U.K.
- Careers language: "Passionate. Principled. Purposeful." Use this as a cue for integrity, communication and customer service, not as a slogan to recite.
- FY2026 revenue was \$9.03B (+7%); company says it continues a digital-first transformation. Mention only if useful to explain interest in a changing enterprise environment.

ROLE PRIORITIES

- Own 1st/2nd-level incidents and requests through resolution and communicated closure.
- Troubleshoot Windows, Mac, apps, networking, AD, M365, Google suite, printers, VoIP/mobile and AV.
- Image/deploy/maintain PCs and Macs; coordinate warranty/service vendors.
- Prioritize a fast queue and know when/how to escalate to L3.
- Keep CMDB/asset records accurate; support pilots, training, documentation and process improvement.

CV PROOF ANCHORS

- 500+ users; Windows + Mac support.
- 45-60 Tier 1/Tier 2 incidents weekly.
- 95% SLA; 4.7/5 CSAT; 88% first-contact resolution.
- 150+ PC/Mac/mobile/peripheral assets deployed or maintained.
- 30+ KB articles -> 15% lower ticket-handling time.
- UB: 300+ service requests; CV reports 60% fewer repeat incidents.

PROBABLE QUESTION MAP - ANSWER HOOK + STORY**OPENING / FIT**

- Tell me about yourself -> "2+ years + cross-platform support + measurable service."
- Why News Corp? -> "Shared technology + exact hands-on overlap + growth/learning environment."
- Why strong fit? -> "Core JD work is already familiar; gaps are learnable and I am honest about depth."
- Why move? -> "More hands-on enterprise desk-side scope and onsite user interaction." (Use only if true.)

BEHAVIORAL / EXPERIENCE

- Difficult problem -> Story 2: isolate before escalating.
- Competing priorities -> Story 1: impact -> urgency/SLA -> dependency -> communicate.
- Difficult user -> Practice Story 4: acknowledge impact -> regain control -> update -> confirm closure.
- Improvement -> Story 5/6: repeated pattern -> standardize -> result.
- Collaboration/escalation -> Story 7: evidence package -> handoff -> retain ownership.
- Learning quickly -> Story 8: understand need -> documentation/lab -> validate -> document.

TECHNICAL / SCENARIO

- Login/MFA -> account -> lock/disable -> MFA -> license/group -> session/device -> validate.
- No network -> scope -> link/IP -> DNS -> VPN -> service/backend.
- Imaging -> assign -> provision -> secure -> patch -> validate -> CMDB -> handoff.
- AV outage -> meeting continuity first -> known-good fallback -> root cause after.
- CMDB -> device/user/location/lifecycle updated during work, not later.
- Escalation -> symptoms + scope + errors + tests + results; keep user ownership.

STORY MAP + GAPS + MUST FOLLOW**8 STORY LABELS**

- 1 High-volume queue: pressure, priority, service.
- 2 First-contact diagnosis: troubleshooting, ownership.
- 3 Endpoint deployment: SCCM, lifecycle, CMDB.
- 4 Difficult user: empathy, expectation setting. PRACTICE.
- 5 KB improvement: initiative, documentation.
- 6 Repeat-incident reduction: root cause, improvement.
- 7 Vendor/L3 escalation: teamwork, follow-through. PRACTICE.
- 8 Learn unfamiliar tool: adaptability. PRACTICE.

GAPS - WORD CAREFULLY

- Google Workspace: M365 is stronger; apply same account/access/sync/service troubleshooting method.
- Adobe Creative Suite: no deep claim; troubleshoot install/update/profile/license/connectivity and use vendor/internal docs.
- macOS Disk Utility: Mac support yes; exact Disk Utility depth only if personally true.
- Depew onsite: confirm relocation/5-day onsite availability before interview.

MUST FOLLOW

- Opening: 45-75 sec. Technical scenarios: ~60-90 sec.
- Behavioral: Hook -> S/T short -> ACTION largest -> Result.
- Say "I" for your actions; "we" only for team context.
- For technical: clarify scope before touching anything.
- Escalation is not abandonment; retain communication/closure.
- Stop after result. Let interviewer pull deeper detail.
- Do not claim Google/Adobe/Disk Utility/management depth you cannot prove.

CLOSING REMINDER: Cross-platform support + measurable service quality + structured troubleshooting + ticket ownership + honest learning agility.

HOW TO ANSWER: HOOK -> S/T BRIEFLY -> ACTION (MOST DETAIL) -> RESULT -> STOP

QUESTION / TEST	HOOK + HOW TO ANSWER	MODEL / STAR EXAMPLE	FOLLOW-UP / COACH NOTE
1. Tell me about yourself. TESTS: Relevance, communication, confidence	"2+ years, cross-platform support, measurable service results." Present role + scale/metrics -> core technical scope -> UB foundation -> why this role. Keep it ~60 sec.	I'm an IT support specialist with a little over two years of corporate Tier 1 and Tier 2 support experience across deskside and remote environments. In my current role I support more than 500 Windows and Mac users and handle around 45 to 60 incidents each week while maintaining 95% SLA compliance, 4.7 out of 5 CSAT and 88% first-contact resolution. My work includes AD/Entra and Microsoft 365 administration, SCCM/MECM deployment, networking, mobile devices, AV and CMDB asset management. Before that at the University at Buffalo I handled in-person deskside support, imaging and network troubleshooting. This role is a strong match because it combines the same hands-on areas in a larger shared-technology environment.	Follow-up: "Which area are you strongest in?" Pick 2-3, then give one proof point.
2. Tell me about a difficult technical problem you solved. TESTS: Diagnosis, independence, technical depth	"I isolate the layer before I escalate." Choose one TRUE incident. Explain symptom/scope, what you ruled out, why you tested each step, validation and documentation.	STAR example using CV framework: S: A user had a work-stopping issue that could have been account, endpoint, application or network related. T: Restore service without unnecessary handoff. A: Clarified the exact symptom and recent changes, reproduced where possible, separated account/device/app/network layers, tested the highest-probability causes, validated each result, then confirmed the fix with the user and documented it. R: This structured approach supports the 88% first-contact resolution reported in my current role. Replace the generic symptom with a real incident before the interview.	Follow-up: "What was the root cause?" You need a real root cause; do not bluff.
3. Tell me about a time you had competing priorities. TESTS: Judgment, calm, SLA awareness	"Impact first, then urgency and dependency." Show what you deprioritized and why. Include communication with waiting users.	S: In a 500+ user environment I regularly manage 45-60 incidents a week. T: Keep urgent work moving without losing lower-priority requests. A: I separate work-stopping/access/security or multi-user issues from routine requests, consider SLA timing and workaround availability, acknowledge lower-priority users, set realistic ETAs, and escalate dependencies with troubleshooting already documented. R: I maintained 95% SLA compliance and 4.7/5 CSAT.	Follow-up: "What would outrank an executive request?" Answer by impact/security/site outage, not title alone.
4. Tell me about a difficult or frustrated user. TESTS: Empathy, control, communication	"Acknowledge the impact, then make the next step clear." Do not argue. Separate emotion from technical problem. Keep user updated until closure.	PRACTICE STAR — adapt to a true case. S: A user was frustrated because an issue had interrupted work and they felt progress was too slow. T: Stabilize the interaction and move troubleshooting forward. A: I acknowledged the impact, restated the issue to confirm understanding, explained what I was checking in plain language, gave a realistic next update time, worked the technical steps, and followed up after the fix. R: The user regained service and understood what had happened and what to expect next.	Follow-up: "What if they stay angry?" Stay calm, set boundaries, involve manager only when behavior/impact requires it.
5. Tell me about a mistake or failure. TESTS: Accountability, maturity	"Own it, correct it, prevent recurrence." Use a TRUE example. Pick a recoverable mistake, not a fake weakness. Show control change.	Answer frame: S/T: Briefly state the mistake and impact. A: Say what YOU did immediately to contain/correct it, who you informed, and what process/documentation/check you changed. R: Explain what improved and what you learned. Do not use an invented metric. If you cannot name a real example, prepare one before the interview.	Follow-up: "Why did it happen?" Give a root cause, not an excuse.
6. Tell me about an improvement you made. TESTS: Initiative, repeatability, documentation	"If it repeats, standardize it." Use Story 5 or 6. Explain pattern -> action -> adoption -> result.	S: Repeated support patterns were creating inconsistent handling. T: Make troubleshooting more repeatable. A: I authored and maintained 30+ knowledge-base articles, troubleshooting guides and standard procedures based on recurring support needs. R: The CV reports a 15% reduction in average ticket-handling time. At UB I also analyzed recurring issues and standardized troubleshooting, contributing to a reported 60% reduction in repeat incidents.	Follow-up: "How did you decide what to document?" Frequency, impact, repeatability and knowledge gaps.
7. Tell me about collaborating with L3 or a vendor. TESTS: Teamwork, escalation quality, ownership	"Escalation is a controlled handoff, not abandonment." Show what evidence you supplied and how you retained user ownership.	PRACTICE STAR — adapt to a real escalation. S: A hardware or service issue required permissions or vendor action outside Tier 2. T: Move it quickly without making the user repeat the story. A: I documented symptoms, scope, errors, steps already tested and results; contacted the correct L3/vendor path; coordinated replacement or advanced troubleshooting; updated the user; and confirmed final closure. R: The next team could act faster because the escalation was complete, and the user still had one accountable contact.	Follow-up: "When do you stop troubleshooting?" When next action requires ownership/access outside scope or time/business risk makes escalation more appropriate.
8. Tell me about learning a new tool or technology quickly. TESTS: Learning agility, self-direction	"Understand the task first; then learn the minimum needed to solve it safely." Show documentation, safe testing, asking focused questions and capturing what you learned.	PRACTICE STAR — adapt to a true example. S: I needed to support a feature or tool I had limited prior exposure to. T: Resolve the user need without pretending expertise. A: I clarified the required outcome, checked internal/vendor documentation, reproduced the issue safely, compared expected vs actual behavior, asked a focused question of a more experienced teammate when needed, validated the fix, and documented the learning. R: The issue was resolved and the knowledge became reusable.	Follow-up: "What tool?" Name a real tool you actually learned.
9. Why should we hire you / what makes you a strong fit? TESTS: Evidence-based fit	"The core work is already familiar; I can contribute quickly and ramp honestly on gaps." Connect 3 JD priorities to 3 proof points. Do not list every tool.	The strongest match is in the day-to-day work: Tier 1/Tier 2 ticket ownership, Windows and Mac support, AD/Entra/M365, endpoint deployment, network and peripheral troubleshooting, AV, asset management and escalation. I also have measurable service evidence: 95% SLA, 4.7/5 CSAT and 88% first-contact resolution. I would be transparent that Google Workspace and Adobe are not my deepest platforms, but the troubleshooting method and enterprise support habits transfer directly.	Follow-up: "What would you need to learn first?" Say company-specific tooling/processes and the identified gaps.

STORY MEMORY: 1 Queue | 2 Diagnose | 3 Deploy | 4 Difficult user (practice) | 5 KB | 6 Repeat issues | 7 L3/vendor (practice) | 8 Learn tool (practice). Practice examples must be replaced/adapted to a comparable true incident before presenting them as personal history.

TECHNICAL ANSWER RULE: CLARIFY SCOPE -> ISOLATE LAYER -> TEST SAFELY -> VALIDATE -> DOCUMENT -> ESCALATE WITH EVIDENCE

QUESTION	WHAT THEY TEST / HOOK	STEP-BY-STEP ANSWER	CV EVIDENCE
1. User cannot log in after password/MFA change.	Identity troubleshooting “Separate account, MFA, session and device.”	Confirm exact error and scope. Check AD/Entra account state, lockout/disablement, password status, MFA registration, relevant license/group if applicable, stale sessions/cached credentials and network reachability. Reset/re-register only when justified. Test sign-in, confirm access, document change. Escalate backend/permissions issues with evidence.	AD/Entra, MFA, provisioning, password resets.
2. Windows/Mac cannot reach corporate resources.	Network isolation “Scope first; endpoint vs network.”	Determine one device/user vs wider impact. Check Wi-Fi/Ethernet link, IP configuration, gateway/DNS reachability, VPN state, recent changes and service status. Compare another device/network when useful. Isolate endpoint config, DHCP/DNS, VPN, wireless, account or backend dependency. Restore or escalate with test results.	TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, Wi-Fi, VPN, Windows/macOS.
3. Walk me through imaging/deploying a new endpoint.	Lifecycle discipline “Assign -> provision -> secure -> patch -> validate -> CMDB -> handoff.”	Confirm user/device and build standard. Use approved imaging/provisioning workflow (SCCM/MECM/Autopilot where applicable), install required apps/security, join/enroll, patch, validate sign-in/network/peripherals, record asset/user/location in CMDB, complete handoff. State PC/Mac-specific tooling only to the level actually used.	150+ assets; SCCM/MECM; Autopilot; CMDB.
4. SCCM deployment fails. What do you check?	Endpoint management reasoning “Determine whether failure is content, client, network, policy or device state.”	Confirm device is reachable and properly discovered/assigned; verify SCCM client health and policy; check available disk/power/network; confirm content/package availability and distribution; review relevant status/error/logs; retry only after cause is understood; document and escalate infrastructure/distribution issues with evidence.	SCCM/MECM deployment experience; exact log depth should match actual experience.
5. Outlook/M365 user cannot send or sync mail.	Application + identity “Separate client, account, network and service.”	Check scope/service status, network, account sign-in/license, mailbox access via web if appropriate, Outlook connection/profile/cache/add-ins/recent changes, and authentication prompts. Recreate profile only when justified. Validate send/receive; document. Escalate mailbox/service-side issues with symptoms and tests.	Microsoft 365, Outlook, Exchange Online, Entra/AD.
6. Network printer is unavailable.	Peripheral + network “Device, queue, network, driver.”	Check whether one user or all users are affected. Verify printer power/status/IP/network reachability, correct queue, stuck jobs, driver, default printer and print service. Test from another device. Clear/restart only when safe. If device/network hardware fault, capture evidence and coordinate replacement/vendor support.	Network printers; TCP/IP; hardware replacement.
7. Conference room fails minutes before a meeting.	AV + prioritization “Meeting continuity first; root cause second.”	Treat as high impact. Identify whether display, audio, camera/mic, cable/dock, room PC, user laptop or meeting app is failing. Use a known-good cable/device or fallback room/laptop path. Get meeting functional first; communicate status; then investigate recurring cause and document after the meeting.	Conference-room AV support.
8. Device is very slow. How do you troubleshoot?	Performance diagnosis “Define when/where it is slow, then check resource, storage, startup and security.”	Clarify all apps vs one app and when it began. Check CPU/memory/disk utilization, free space, startup processes, updates/reboot status, security scan/Defender state, network dependency and recent software changes. Compare symptoms after controlled steps. Avoid random cleanup tools. Validate performance and document cause.	Windows 10/11, macOS, Defender/endpoint support.
9. Remote user cannot connect to VPN.	Remote support “Internet first, then client/authentication, then corporate reachability.”	Confirm general internet access, exact VPN error, account/MFA state, client version/configuration, date/time, recent password change, network restrictions and service status. Test alternate network if appropriate. Avoid changing multiple variables at once. Validate internal resource access after connection.	VPN, remote support, MFA.
10. How do you decide when to escalate to L3/vendor?	Judgment + ownership “Escalate when the next safe action needs ownership/access outside Tier 2 or time risk is rising.”	First establish scope and complete reasonable Tier 2 tests. Escalate for privileged backend changes, infrastructure faults, vendor warranty/replacement, product defects or business-critical incidents where continued local testing adds delay/risk. Package symptoms, scope, errors/logs, steps and results. Continue user updates and confirm closure.	L3/vendor coordination; escalation ownership.
11. Why does CMDB accuracy matter and when do you update it?	Operational discipline “Asset data is part of the support work, not admin afterthought.”	CMDB should reflect device identity, assigned user, location, status and lifecycle. Update during deployment, move, replacement, loaner/return and retirement. Cross-check serial/asset details before closure. Accurate data supports support history, inventory, replacement planning and accountability.	Asset inventory, hardware lifecycle, CMDB.
12. How would you support Google Workspace or Adobe if unfamiliar?	Learning agility + honesty “Be honest about platform depth; strong on troubleshooting method.”	Acknowledge M365 is stronger. Clarify exact symptom. Check install/version, account/access/license, profile/configuration, browser/client behavior, sync, network/service dependency and recent changes. Use internal/vendor documentation, reproduce safely, document findings and escalate product-specific defects with evidence. Do not pretend deep admin experience.	M365/enterprise app support; gap bridge.
13. How do you support iOS/Android mobile devices?	Mobile endpoint support “Start with enrollment/account/connectivity /app scope.”	Clarify device/OS/version and whether issue is cellular, Wi-Fi, mail/app access, account/MFA or device management. Check connectivity, account state, app/client settings, updates and approved enrollment/profile requirements. Protect user data; avoid destructive reset until backup/policy and escalation path are clear.	iOS/Android and mobile device support.
14. What would you check on a Mac startup/storage issue?	Mac depth / Disk Utility gap “Differentiate startup, filesystem/storage and user-profile symptoms.”	Clarify exact startup/storage behavior, free space and recent changes. Use built-in diagnostics/approved tools only to the depth you know, review disk/storage health symptoms, safe boot/recovery options if within procedure, and protect data before repair steps. State Disk Utility experience honestly; escalate when filesystem/hardware repair exceeds your depth.	macOS support; Disk Utility depth must be truthful.

COMPANY / JD-SPECIFIC PROBABLE QUESTIONS

QUESTION	WHY THEY MAY ASK	HOW TO ANSWER / MODEL NOTES
1. You receive a work-stopping login issue, a conference-room failure before a meeting, and several normal requests at once. How do you prioritize?	JD explicitly requires triage, AV and ticket ownership.	Hook: “Business impact, time sensitivity, users affected, workaround.” Example: acknowledge all tickets; stabilize meeting if imminent/high impact; parallel-check access issue if security/work-stopping; communicate ETAs; document; pull in teammate/L3 if justified. Show that priority is based on impact, not job title alone.
2. How would you support users across different News Corp business units in a shared-services model?	Global Technology supports several business units.	Hook: “Consistent standards, but communicate to the user’s context.” Use approved process/KB, capture business impact, avoid assumptions, document clearly enough for another team to continue, protect data/access boundaries, and keep the user informed through resolution.
3. The JD says you may pilot/test new hardware or software. How would you approach a pilot?	They want controlled change, not just break/fix.	Define success criteria and target users; understand support/security dependencies; test common workflows and failure cases; record issues; gather user feedback; communicate limitations; document rollback/escalation path; feed results into launch documentation/training.
4. How would you train a new employee or explain an application to a nontechnical user?	JD includes application training/new employee support.	Start from the user’s task, not features. Demonstrate the minimum workflow, let them perform it, give one short reference/KB link, confirm understanding, and document repeated confusion points that may need better onboarding material.
5. A warranty laptop has recurring hardware failure. What do you do?	JD includes vendor/service-provider coordination.	Confirm issue and rule out software/config causes; capture serial/warranty/diagnostic evidence; protect user data; arrange loaner/workaround if needed; open vendor case with complete details; update CMDB during replacement; validate user setup and close loop.
6. You are asked to create a desktop communication about a change. What makes it effective?	JD includes communications/announcements.	State what is changing, who is affected, when, user action required, expected impact, support/contact path and any workaround. Use plain language and test instructions from a user perspective before sending.
7. How would you improve technical documentation?	JD explicitly asks to manage/improve documentation.	Prioritize high-frequency/high-impact issues, write clear prerequisites and decision steps, include escalation criteria, validate with another technician, update after product/process changes, and remove duplicate/outdated guidance. Use 30+ KB articles/15% handling-time result as evidence.

OPENING ANSWERS - MODEL THE STRUCTURE, THEN SPEAK NATURALLY

QUESTION	MODEL ANSWER
Tell me about yourself	I’m an IT support specialist with a little over two years of corporate Tier 1 and Tier 2 support experience across deskside and remote environments. In my current role I support 500+ Windows and Mac users and handle roughly 45–60 incidents per week while maintaining 95% SLA compliance, 4.7/5 CSAT and 88% first-contact resolution. My work covers AD/Entra/Microsoft 365, SCCM/MECM deployment, networking, mobile devices, AV and CMDB asset management. Before that at the University at Buffalo I handled in-person deskside support, imaging and network troubleshooting. News Corp stands out because the role combines the same hands-on areas in a larger shared-technology environment.
Why News Corp?	The role is attractive because Global Technology supports several News Corp businesses through a shared-services model, so good support, documentation and communication have impact beyond one local team. The JD also lines up closely with what I already do across Windows, Mac, identity, endpoint deployment, networking, AV and asset management. News Corp is also continuing a digital-first transformation, so it looks like an environment where I can contribute with my current foundation while continuing to learn new platforms and processes.
Why are you a strong fit?	The core responsibilities are already familiar to me: Tier 1/Tier 2 ticket ownership, Windows and Mac support, AD/Entra/Microsoft 365, endpoint deployment, networking and peripherals, AV, asset management and escalation. I can also point to measurable service results such as 95% SLA, 4.7/5 CSAT and 88% first-contact resolution. Where I have less direct depth, such as Google Workspace or Adobe, I would be transparent and use the same structured troubleshooting and learning approach.

GAP HANDLING + QUESTIONS TO ASK + FINAL CHECK

GAPS - EXACT WORDING - Google Workspace: “It is not the primary platform shown on my CV. My closest experience is M365 and enterprise account/access support. I would apply the same structured method while learning News Corp’s specific workflows.” - Adobe: “Not my deepest product area. I can troubleshoot install/update, permissions, profile/config, licensing/connectivity symptoms and use internal/vendor resources for product-specific defects.” - macOS Disk Utility: “I support macOS, but I would describe Disk Utility only to the level I have personally used it.” - Onsite Depew: candidate must confirm. If true, state clearly that five-day onsite is acceptable and relocation/commute plan is understood.	TOP QUESTIONS TO ASK - What are the most common endpoint or user-support issues at the Depew site? - How is ownership divided between local deskside support and centralized third-level teams? - What should this person be able to handle independently by the end of 90 days? - Backup: Are there endpoint refresh, pilot or collaboration-tool changes the team is currently supporting?	FINAL CHECK - Sound like an experienced support IC, not a manager. - Give method + judgment + communication + result. - For every story, know what YOU did. - For technical answers, explain sequence, not tool names. - Do not overclaim gaps. - Close the loop: validate, document, communicate.
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FINAL CLOSING: “The core work here is very close to what I have been doing: cross-platform Tier 1/Tier 2 support, endpoint deployment, identity/M365, network troubleshooting, AV and asset management. I am disciplined about troubleshooting, documentation, escalation and user communication, and I would be ready to contribute in those areas while continuing to expand in News Corp’s environment.”